

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2022 - Round 2

Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 54)

Q 3.1: Max 12 - In each main clause and bracketed relative clause: award 2 points if correct, 1 point with one mistake. If the relative clause is misplaced, treat that as a mistake in the relative clause.

E.g., "(b) *The teacher has also washed him, who I caught*" gains 2 for the main clause, 1 for the relative.

In (c) only mark one answer, and award the highest number of possible marks.

Q 3.2: Max 18 - In each main clause and bracketed relative clause: 3 marks if all correct, 2 marks if one mistake, 1 mark if two mistakes. If the relative clause is misplaced, treat that as a mistake in the relative clause.

E.g., "(c) **Ne tā he faiaoga e vaka ne kitia e Mele**" gains 3 for the main clause, 2 for the relative.

Q 3.1	(a) <i>There are only birds.</i> (Max 2)
	(b) <i>The teacher [that I caught] has also washed him.</i> (Max 4)
	(c) <i>The child [that the bird saw] will have plenty of canoes [that Sione will wash.]</i> <i>The child [that the bird [that Sione will wash] saw] will have plenty of canoes.</i> <i>The child will have plenty of canoes [that the bird [that Sione will wash] saw.]</i> (Max 6)
Q 3.2	(a) To totou foki a ia. (Max 3)
	(b) Kua fai ika noa a Sione [ka kai he faiaoga]. (Max 6)
	(c) Ne tā he faiaoga [ne kitia e Mele] e vaka. (Max 6)
	(d) Kua muhu kāmuta tūmau. (Max 3)

Q 3.3: Max 24 – Broken down as follows:

Basic syntax: 3

Relative clauses: 3

Tense marking: 3

Case marking: 6

Existential verbs: 4

Fronting: 5

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Commentary

- The default word order is *Tense + Verb + (Adverb) + Subject + Object*
- Tense markers are as follows:

Past	ne
Perfect	kua
Present	∅
Future	to

- Nouns must be preceded by a case marker:

	Ergative	Absolutive
Name / Pronoun	e	a
Else	he	e

- The ergative is used for the subject of a relative clause, or a subject if it is followed by an object; the absolutive is used elsewhere.
- They can be followed by a relative clause.
 - Relative clauses are introduced by **ne** if the clause is in the past tense, and **ka** in the future, then follow typical syntax.
- Verbs come in two types: existential verbs, **fai** *be/have* and **muhu** *be/have plenty*; and general verbs.
 - Existential verbs are translated as *there + be* without a subject, and as *have* with a subject.
 - The object is compulsory. The head noun is moved to come directly after the verb, and does not appear with case markers. Relative clauses stay in the object position.
 - Note that existential verbs are always treated as intransitive, i.e., subjects of existential verbs are absolutive.

Massam (2001), *Pseudo Noun Incorporation in Niuean*: <http://www.jstor.org/stable/404791>.

Massam (2000), *VSO and VOS: Aspects of Niuean Word Order*. In Andrew Carnie and Eithne Guilfoyle (eds), *The Syntax of Verb Initial Languages*.